LEO FENG

leofeng-ca.github.io

EDUCATION

Mila / Université de Montréal — Montreal, Canada
Ph.D. in Computer Science (Supervised by Prof. Yoshua Bengio) — *Sep 2020 - Nov 2025*

· Fast Track from M.Sc. program (Sep 2020 - Aug 2021)

University of Oxford — Oxford, UK
First Class Honours, B.A. in Computer Science

· Thesis supervised by Prof. Shimon Whiteson and Luisa Zintgraf

MACHINE LEARNING RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

RBC Borealis — Toronto, Canada
Machine Learning Research Team Lead — *Oct 2026 - Present*
Senior Machine Learning Researcher — *May 2026 - Oct 2026*
Machine Learning Researcher — *Jan 2025 - May 2026*

RBC Borealis (Formerly Borealis AI) — Vancouver, Canada
Research Intern — *Jan 2022 - Dec 2024*

· Supervised by: Mohamed O. Ahmed, Frederick Tung, Hossein Hajimirsadeghi, and formerly Amir Abdi.
· Resulted in 4 published first-author papers: 2x ICLR 2023, 1x ICLR 2024, 1x ICML 2024
· Worked on (1) selective prediction (ICLR 2023) and (2) scalable attention-based modules for set-structured data (ICLR 2023 and ICML 2024) and sequence data (ICLR 2024 and arXiv preprint).

University of Oxford — Oxford, UK
Research Intern — *Jun 2019 - Oct 2019*

· Supervised by: Prof. Shimon Whiteson and Luisa Zintgraf
· Worked on extending meta-learning methods via a learned loss function (NeurIPS Workshop 2019)

Brave Software — London, UK
Research Intern — *Jun 2018 - Sep 2018*

· Supervised by Panagiotis Tigas
· Worked on a recommender system for delivering personalized ads and click-through rate predictions

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

[**NeurIPS 2026**] B. Shayegh, M. Ahmed, F. Tung, and **L. Feng**. Can LLMs Take Retrieved Information with a Grain of Salt? *NeurIPS*, 2026.

[**NeurIPS 2026**] Y. Choi, H. Sheikhi, **L. Feng**, and H. Lee. Off-Policy Evaluation of Large Language Models via Learned Semantic Bottleneck Embeddings. *NeurIPS*, 2026.

[**ICLR 2025**] M. Kim, S. Choi, T. Yun, E. Bengio, **L. Feng**, J. Rector-Brooks, S. Ahn, J. Park, N. Malkin, and Y. Bengio. Adaptive Teachers for Amortized Samplers. *ICLR*, 2025.

[**ICML 2024**] **L. Feng**, F. Tung, H. Hajimirsadeghi, Y. Bengio, and M. Ahmed. Memory Efficient Neural Processes via Constant Memory Attention Block. *ICML*, 2024.

[**ICLR 2024**] **L. Feng**, F. Tung, H. Hajimirsadeghi, Y. Bengio, and M. Ahmed. Tree Cross Attention. *ICLR*, 2024.

[**ICLR 2023**] **L. Feng**, H. Hajimirsadeghi, Y. Bengio, and M. Ahmed. Latent Bottlenecked Attentive Neural Processes. *ICLR*, 2023.

[**ICLR 2023**] **L. Feng**, M. Ahmed, H. Hajimirsadeghi, and A. Abdi. Towards Better Selective Classification. *ICLR*, 2023.

[**ICLR 2022**] T. Deleu, D. Kanaa, **L. Feng**, G. Kerg, Y. Bengio, G. Lajoie, and P. Bacon. Continuous-Time Meta-Learning with Forward Mode Differentiation. *ICLR*, **Spotlight Presentation**, 2022.

[**ICML 2021**] L. Zintgraf, **L. Feng**, C. Lu, M. Igl, K. Hartikainen, K. Hofmann, and S. Whiteson. Exploration in Approximate Hyper-State Space for Meta Reinforcement Learning. *ICML*, 2021.

[**JMLR 2021**] L. Zintgraf, S. Schulze, C. Lu, **L. Feng**, M. Igl, K. Shiarlis, Y. Gal, K. Hofmann, and S. Whiteson. VariBAD: Variational Bayes-Adaptive Deep RL via Meta-Learning. *Journal of Machine Learning Research (JMLR)*, 2021.

SELECTED PREPRINTS AND WORKSHOP PAPERS

[**Preprint**] Y. Choi, **L. Feng**, V. Liu, and H. Lee. Amortized Off-Policy Evaluation for LLMs. *arXiv*, 2026.

[**NeurIPS Workshop 2026**] J. Qin, R. Deng, M. Ahmed, F. Tung, and **L. Feng**. From AutoResearch to Continual AutoResearch: Do Agents Learn Across Tasks? *NeurIPS Workshop on Managing Agents that Manage Agents*, 2026.

[**Preprint**] **L. Feng**, F. Tung, M. Ahmed, Y. Bengio, and H. Hajimirsadeghi. Were RNNs All We Needed? *arXiv*, 2024.

[**Preprint**] **L. Feng**, F. Tung, H. Hajimirsadeghi, M. Ahmed, Y. Bengio, and G. Mori. Attention as an RNN. *arXiv*, 2024.

PATENTS AND APPLICATIONS

US18/316,105 and **CA3199276A** - Selective classification with alternate selection mechanism

SELECTED TALKS

DLRLSS, Talk 2025

SELECTED AWARDS/ACHIEVEMENTS

Outstanding Reviewer, ICML (Top 10%) 2022

Scholarship ($96,000), FRQNT Doctoral (B2X) Scholarship 2022 - 2026

Scholarship ($17,500), Canada Graduate Scholarship (CGS-M) Scholarship 2021

Scholarship ($7000), UdeM Fast-Track to PhD Scholarship 2021

Scholarship ($3500), UdeM Excellence Scholarship (Bourse d'Excellence) 2021

Fellowship ($12,500), Molecule Discovery Fellowship 2020

Scholarship ($6500), UdeM FAS AI Scholarship 2020

Scholarship ($3500), UdeM Excellence Scholarship (Bourse d'Excellence) 2020

Bronze Medal, NWERC ACM ICPC, *Netherlands* 2018

Bronze Medal, NWERC ACM ICPC, *UK* 2017

Olympiads: Bronze Medal, International Olympiad in Informatics (IOI); Gold Medal, Canadian Computing Olympiad; 1st Place (of 1925), Canadian Computing Competition; Platinum Division, USA Computing Olympiad; competed in USAMO, CMO, and APMO

TEACHING

Teaching Assistant, "**Representation Learning**" and "**Fundamentals of Machine Learning**" Courses, Université de Montréal, Canada, Fall 2021

Teaching Assistant, "**IVADO/Mila Deep Learning School**", Mila, Canada, Summer 2021

Teaching Assistant, "**Design and Analysis of Algorithms**" and "**Concurrent Programming**" Courses, University of Oxford, UK, Hilary Term 2020

REVIEWER

NeurIPS, ICML, ICLR, AAAI (Social Impact Track)